

Public Companies: Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity

Securing the power grid, water systems, industrial control systems, and the networks underneath everything else on your lists

Context: This category connects directly back to your power, defense, and AI infrastructure lists -- every grid operator, drone maker, and data center you've researched is a potential target. Energy is now the 4th most-targeted sector (10% of incidents). NERC's January 2026 Critical Infrastructure Protection Roadmap flags that defense-in-depth protections now cover a shrinking share of grid assets as low-impact/distributed assets (solar inverters, EVs, distributed energy resources) proliferate outside traditional oversight. New CIP-015 standards mandating internal network monitoring for utilities are phasing in through 2030, creating durable, regulation-driven demand.

1. OT/ICS & Industrial Cybersecurity

The category most directly matched to 'critical infrastructure': securing SCADA, industrial control systems, and operational technology rather than conventional IT.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Palo Alto Networks	PANW	Network, cloud, and endpoint security plus dedicated OT/industrial security offerings	Expanded OT security through industrial protocol analysis and network segmentation solutions targeting energy, utilities, transportation, and manufacturing
Fortinet	FTNT	Comprehensive security for enterprise and industrial networks; strong OT/ICS presence	One of the largest cybersecurity vendors by revenue with continued double-digit growth and strong profitability
Cisco Systems	CSCO	Secure industrial networking: network segmentation, zero-trust access, industrial visibility for converged IT/OT environments	Launched industrial network architecture with security controls built in (2025); 2024 Splunk acquisition added SIEM/security analytics

Note: the two most specialized pure-play OT security vendors -- Dragos and Claroty -- remain private. Dragos partners directly with GE Vernova on grid cybersecurity; Claroty has strategic backing from Rockwell Automation, Schneider Electric, and Siemens and raised a Series F in January 2026 while explicitly positioning for a future IPO. Both are worth tracking as prospective listings given how central they are to this exact theme.

2. Diversified Industrial & Physical Security Conglomerates

Large companies for whom critical infrastructure cybersecurity is one part of a broader industrial or defense business -- lower-beta exposure to this theme.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Honeywell	HON	Integrated physical security, industrial cybersecurity, and OT visibility platforms	Dominates the North American critical infrastructure protection market alongside General Dynamics and Motorola Solutions per 2026 market analysis
Motorola Solutions	MSI	Resilient communications and physical security platforms for critical infrastructure and public safety	Core player in integrated physical-plus-cyber protection for utilities, government, and public safety networks
Rockwell Automation	ROK	Industrial automation control systems; strategic partner/investor in OT security specialist Claroty	Positioned to benefit from OT security demand growth through its Claroty relationship without owning the pure-play risk

General Dynamics	GD	Defense and critical infrastructure protection systems (see also Defense/Drone list)	Named a North American CIP market leader alongside Honeywell and Motorola Solutions
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3. General-Purpose Cybersecurity Leaders

Broad enterprise/cloud security vendors -- not critical-infrastructure-specific, but foundational since power, defense, and telecom operators all run on the same IT security stack underneath their OT layer.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
CrowdStrike	CRWD	Cloud-native endpoint detection and response platform	Strong sales growth and profitability despite a high-profile July 2024 outage that briefly hit shares; remains a category leader
Zscaler	ZS	Cloud-native zero-trust network security	Core zero-trust infrastructure vendor as hybrid IT/OT/cloud environments expand the attack surface
SentinelOne	S	AI-driven endpoint security and autonomous threat response	Opened its Purple AI agentic investigation tool to all customers (June 2026), pushing AI-driven SOC automation
Check Point Software	CHKP	Network security and threat prevention platforms	Long-tenured network security incumbent with continued enterprise and infrastructure exposure
Okta	OKTA	Identity and access management	Core identity layer increasingly required for zero-trust architectures across converged IT/OT environments

4. Network Monitoring, DDoS Protection & Vulnerability Management

Carrier-grade and infrastructure-scale monitoring -- protecting the networks that connect grid operators, defense contractors, and telecoms rather than individual endpoints.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Netscout Systems	NTCT	Network performance monitoring and DDoS protection (Arbor) used by carriers and large enterprises	Omnis platform combines deep packet inspection with threat detection for carrier and infrastructure customers
Qualys	QLYS	Cloud-based vulnerability management, compliance, and attack-surface scanning	Achieved FedRAMP High authorization for TotalCloud (May 2026), extending protection to government cloud workloads
Tenable Holdings	TENB	Vulnerability management and exposure assessment platform	Core vulnerability-scanning vendor for enterprise and government infrastructure customers
Akamai Technologies	AKAM	Edge platform combining content delivery with web application, API, and DDoS protection	Security now a major and expanding share of revenue alongside its CDN business; recognized in 2026 Gartner Peer Insights for edge distribution

5. Identity, Data & Hybrid-Cloud Security

Increasingly relevant to critical infrastructure specifically because utilities and industrial operators are moving OT data into hybrid and multi-cloud environments -- cited as the fastest-growing sub-segment through 2033.

Company	Ticker	Role	Recent Signal (2026)
Varonis Systems	VRNS	Data security posture management: discovers, classifies, and monitors sensitive data across on-prem and cloud	Shifted to a SaaS model with automated, AI-assisted data protection
Broadcom	AVGO	Owns the Symantec enterprise security business (endpoint, network, web, data-loss-prevention)	Security is one segment within a much larger chips/infrastructure-software business (see also AI Power/Networking lists)
IBM	IBM	Identity management, data security (Guardium), security operations, and X-Force threat intelligence	Security bundled within a diversified software/consulting business rather than a standalone growth driver

Categories Worth Adding

- **Water Sector-Specific Security** — water utilities are explicitly called out as an emerging, under-protected target (legacy SCADA, minimal budgets); no clean public pure-play currently exists, similar to the gallium/germanium gap in your critical minerals list.
- **Distributed Energy Resource (DER) Security** — solar inverters, EV chargers, and residential battery systems are flagged by 2026 industry sources as a rapidly expanding, largely unprotected attack surface distinct from traditional grid/utility security -- worth its own pass given how much distributed generation appears in your AI Power Supply Chain list.
- **Cyber Insurance** — as critical infrastructure cyber risk becomes quantifiable and regulated, insurers underwriting this risk are a downstream financial beneficiary category not covered here.

Generated July 10, 2026. This is a disjoint reference set, not a ranked or filtered list.